

Odisha Gram Panchayat Development -- Analytical Findings Report

Department of Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water, Government of Odisha

Automated MetaInsight Analysis

Activity Lifecycle - Every Planned Work and Its Money

Spending Remains Below Both Plan and Sanction

The sample-wide SPENT-minus-PLANNED balance is Rs -51.96 crore; the negative sign means voucher-linked spending remains below the planned cost. No Gram Panchayat has a positive aggregate balance, although individual activities may still have spending above plan. The largest absolute negative balances are in **Biswamathpur**, at Rs -7.23 crore against 4.3% of all activities, and **Kalimela**, at Rs -5.90 crore against 6.7% of activities. These are totals, not performance rates, but their scale warrants activity-level examination.

The gap is concentrated in the two main work types. New/Fresh activities have a SPENT-minus-PLANNED balance of Rs -34.36 crore, while Maintenance has Rs -15.11 crore. New/Fresh activities account for 11,047 activities, or 87.0%, and Maintenance for 1,207 activities, or 9.5%. The Department should therefore test whether expenditure is lagging, planned costs remain overstated, or spending links are incomplete; the data does not distinguish among these possibilities.

For activities with sanction records, the SPENT-minus-SANCTIONED balance is Rs -5.02 crore. **Sheragada** block records Rs -85.77 lakh against 7.2% of the sample's activity volume, and **Rangeilunda** records Rs -82.57 lakh against 9.2%. **Khallikote** records Rs 0 against 5.0% of activity volume. These activity shares cover the whole view, not just activities with sanction records. Since sanction records cover only about 17% of activities, these balances should be reviewed work by work rather than treated as block-wide sanction performance.

Planned Money Is Concentrated in Village Infrastructure

Theme 6 – Self-sufficient Infrastructure in Village carries Rs 30.07 crore of planned untied funding, or 50.4% of the Rs 59.64 crore total. Theme 4 – Water Sufficient Village follows with Rs 11.63 crore, or 19.5%. This infrastructure-led pattern holds in 18 of the 20 Gram Panchayats.

The exceptions are operationally important. In **Boipariguda**, the largest planned untied amount sits under Unmapped theme rather than a named LSDG theme. In **Kalimela**, Theme 4 – Water

Sufficient Village is the leading theme. Boipariguda's unmapped concentration requires the underlying focus areas to be checked and correctly mapped before its plan can be assessed against LSDG priorities.

Across every fiscal year, Sanitation and Drinking water are the two largest focus areas among activities recorded as started. Sanitation accounts for 620 activities, or 29.1%, and Drinking water for 548 activities, or 25.8%. This establishes where implementation activity is concentrated, but not where the largest planned or spent amounts sit.

The Lifecycle Is Stalling at Recorded Approval Status

Activity Approved is the recorded status for 10,108 activities, or 79.6% of all 12,704 activities. WORK ONGOING accounts for 2,110 activities, or 16.6%, while WORK ABANDONED accounts for 420 activities, or 3.3%. **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** are the two Gram Panchayats where Activity Approved does not clearly dominate the status mix and should be examined separately.

The largest SPENT-minus-PLANNED balance also sits against Activity Approved: Rs -41.61 crore. WORK ABANDONED carries Rs -5.64 crore and WORK ONGOING Rs -4.24 crore. This makes status updating and expenditure reconciliation central review issues. Only 17 activities are marked WORK COMPLETED, so the recorded completion field cannot support a meaningful comparison of Gram Panchayat performance.

Sanction Records Need Targeted Verification

Chikilli has Rs 0 in recorded SANCTIONED-basis proposed cost across every fiscal year, despite accounting for 5.0% of all activities. Both interpretations remain open: either no sanction amounts were recorded for these activities, or the sanction information is missing from this dataset. The block should be asked to establish which is correct.

The results supplied here do not establish which sanctioning office dominates by district or block. That question should therefore be tested directly from the sanction register, including the low-count sanctioning-authority entries that remain uncleaned.

Questions for the Departmental Review

1. For **Chikilli**, does Rs 0 across all years mean that no sanction amounts were entered, or that sanctions were issued but not captured, and which sanctioning office must reconcile the records?
2. In **Sheragada** and **Rangeilunda** blocks, which sanctioned activities make up the Rs -85.77 lakh and Rs -82.57 lakh balances, and what status and geotagged evidence are on file for each?
3. In **Biswamathpur** and **Kalimela**, which activities account for the largest negative balances against plan, and does an activity-level review identify any Gram Panchayat repeatedly spending above plan across fiscal years?

> **Reading note:** this view has one row for each of the **12,704 activities** the 20 Gram Panchayats planned, and three of its properties are features of the data rather than results. First, **costless**

activities -- training, campaigns and services planned without a cost -- only began being reported in 2023-24, and they are 7,074 of the 12,704 rows, so activity counts rise about eightfold at that boundary for a reporting reason. Second, Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. Third, only **17 activities are marked WORK COMPLETED** in the whole sample, so completion rates here measure recording practice, not delivery. Activity-count comparisons across FY 2023-24 reflect a change in reporting completeness (costless activities begin being recorded), not a change in activity.

Monthly Money Flows by Gram Panchayat

Spending Is Rising, but Still Concentrated Around Year-End

Cashbook expenditure linked to GDP activities shows an increasing trend across months, quarters and fiscal years. Across the period, activity-linked expenditure totalled Rs 24.00 crore. However, the flow was not steady: January–March repeatedly recorded the largest quarterly totals, consistent with the known concentration of payments in March. The highest quarter was 2026-Q1 at Rs 1.99 crore, accounting for 8.3% of the total, followed by 2025-Q1 at Rs 1.92 crore and 8.0%, 2023-Q1 at Rs 1.79 crore and 7.4%, and 2022-Q1 at Rs 1.76 crore and 7.3%.

Payment amounts, receipt amounts and their voucher counts all show a recurring annual cycle. Activity-linked expenditure follows a shorter three-month rhythm. Operationally, increasing expenditure is positive only if Gram Panchayats can process it without relying heavily on March. District and block reviews should therefore examine whether expenditure is being spread across the fiscal year or repeatedly accumulating for year-end clearance.

The recorded Rs 0 activity-linked expenditure in both 2020-Q2 and 2020-Q3 also requires confirmation. The data cannot distinguish between no expenditure and expenditure not entered or not linked to activities; officials should establish which applies.

Most Areas Increased Expenditure, but Several Followed Different Paths

Six districts—Khordha, Sundargarh, Malkangiri, Rayagada, Ganjam and Kandhamal—showed a clear increase in quarterly activity-linked expenditure. **Bargarh, Cuttack and Koraput** followed different time patterns and should not be managed on the assumption that the statewide trajectory applies equally to them.

At block level, increasing quarterly activity-linked expenditure was evident in Bhubaneswar, Lahunipara, Kalimela, Kalyansingpur, Balisankara, Sheragada, Khajuripada, Laxmipur and Khallikote. The exceptions were **Barpali, Bheden, Baranga, Attabira, Rangeilunda, Boipariguda and Tangi Choudwar**. Their different patterns do not by themselves establish weak delivery, but they identify where month-by-month scrutiny is needed to locate pauses, surges or reversals.

District cycles also differed. Khordha, Bargarh, Cuttack, Ganjam and Koraput shared one recurring pattern, while **Sundargarh** and **Rayagada** followed different cycles. **Malkangiri** and **Kandhamal** did not show the same clear recurring pattern. Review discussions should focus on the actual months in which cashbook expenditure rose or stalled rather than applying one seasonal expectation to every district.

Transaction Volume Is Highly Concentrated

The **Bhubaneswar** block recorded 2,135 payment vouchers, representing 25.0% of the 8,529 vouchers in the sample. It was the standout block in five of the six fiscal years; 2024-2025 was the exception, when no single block clearly stood apart. This is a concentration of transaction volume, not in itself a measure of performance.

The same concentration extends across cashbook payment amounts, receipt amounts, payment counts and receipt counts. In 2025-2026, Bhubaneswar and **Rangailunda** were the leading two blocks across those four measures and activity-linked expenditure. At district level, **Ganjam** stood out in 2025-2026 for payment amounts, receipt amounts, receipt counts, activity-linked expenditure, sanction counts and sanctioned amounts; payment-voucher count followed a different pattern. These concentrations warrant checks on transaction composition and reconciliation, rather than conclusions based on totals alone.

Sanctions and Cash Movements Do Not Share One Timing Pattern

Sanction counts increased when viewed by quarter and fiscal year, but their month-to-month pattern differed. Sanctioned amounts also rose through the months and quarters of 2020-2021. This indicates that sanctions and cashbook flows should be reviewed as separate sequences rather than assumed to move together.

Ganjam presents the clearest timing break. Payment amounts, receipt amounts and both voucher counts shifted around August 2020; sanction counts and sanctioned amounts shifted around October 2020, while activity-linked expenditure shifted around November 2020. The sequence is visible, but its cause is not established in the data.

For the next departmental review, the officer should ask:

- What changed in **Ganjam** between August and November 2020, and do the underlying cashbook and sanction records support the sequence shown?
- What month-level explanations do **Bargarh**, **Cuttack**, **Koraput** and the seven exception blocks provide for their different activity-linked expenditure patterns?
- In **Bhubaneswar** and **Rangailunda**, what transactions account for the high voucher volume, and are monthly receipts, payments and cashbook balances fully reconciled?

> **Reading note:** this view's time axis is the **cashbook's own 72 months** (April 2020 to March 2026), and a Gram Panchayat month with no transactions is present as a row of zeros rather than absent -- 259 of the 1,440 cells are such months. Two consequences follow. Sanctions are counted by **sanction month**, so the **2,040** sanctions dated inside the window are here and **61** dated outside

it are not; the yearly report card counts the full 2,101 by fiscal year, and both totals are correct for their own axis. And **March concentrates payments every year** -- 2,040 of the 8,529 payment vouchers fall in a March -- which is the fiscal-year end, a known property of government cash flow.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

Recorded Completion Is Weakening Across Most Gram Panchayats

Recorded completed activities show a decreasing trajectory in 17 of the 20 Gram Panchayats. Across the sample, only 17 activities were recorded as completed over the six fiscal years. The highest annual totals were 6 activities in 2021-2022 and 6 activities in 2022-2023, each accounting for 35.3% of all recorded completions. This compares with 3 activities in 2020-2021, 2 activities in 2024-2025, and 0 activities in both 2023-2024 and 2025-2026.

The decreasing pattern covers Hirlipali, Bandhpali, Bhatigaon, Bheden, Dadhapatna, Govindapur, Chikilli, Biswamathpur, Sharagada, Barimunda, Itipur, Boipariguda, Laxmipur, Kalyansinghpur, Karuabahal, Haldikudar and Mendarajpur. This is too widespread to treat as a small number of isolated weak years. For each of these Gram Panchayats, officials should reconcile planned activities, sanctions, cashbook expenditure, completion status and photographic evidence by fiscal year.

The exceptions are **Dutimendi**, **Andhrua** and **Kalimela**, where no clear completion trajectory was found. That does not establish stronger performance: it means their yearly records fluctuate or do not form a consistent direction. Their individual report cards therefore need review rather than comparison against the dominant pattern alone.

The Same Concern Is Visible at Block Level

Recorded completion also decreases across 13 of the 16 blocks: Attabira, Barpali, Bheden, Baranga, Tangi Choudwar, Khallikote, Rangeilunda, Sheragada, Boipariguda, Laxmipur, Kalyansingpur, Balisankara and Lahunipara. The pattern appearing at both Gram Panchayat and block level gives block officials a clear accountability task: determine whether activities remain unfinished or whether completed work has not been entered as completed.

The block-level exceptions are **Khajuripada**, **Bhubaneswar** and **Kalimela**, where there is no clear trajectory. Officials from these blocks should be asked to identify the particular Gram Panchayat-years behind the irregular pattern and show the corresponding sanction, payment, completion and evidence records.

Bargarh Shows Broad Balance, but Not Across the Whole Pipeline

Across the sampled Gram Panchayats in **Bargarh district**, ten measures were distributed relatively evenly. These included the number of activities, activities recorded without a cost, expenditure on

the spent basis, differences between spending and planned or sanctioned amounts, administrative and technical sanction records, ongoing activities, activities with photographic evidence and total evidence uploads.

However, this broad balance did not extend consistently to the number of plans, total sanctioned value or completed activities. Planned-costed activities, total planned cost, cashbook payments, cashbook receipts and abandoned activities followed different distributions across Bargarh's Gram Panchayats. An even share of activities or evidence therefore should not be read as proof that each Gram Panchayat converts plans into sanctions, payments and completed work equally well. The district should present the stages together for each fiscal year rather than defend performance using any single count.

Questions for the Departmental Review

- In the 17 Gram Panchayats with decreasing recorded completion, are activities not being completed, or are completion updates not being entered? Can each block produce an activity-wise reconciliation from plan through sanction, payment and photographic evidence?
- What accounts for the irregular records in **Dutimendi**, **Andhrua** and **Kalimela**, and in **Khajuripada**, **Bhubaneswar** and **Kalimela** blocks? Which fiscal years and pipeline stages require correction?
- In **Bargarh district**, which Gram Panchayats account for the different distributions of planned cost, cashbook payments, cashbook receipts and abandoned activities, and do their expenditure records have corresponding sanctions and photographic evidence?

> **Reading note:** this view is a full grid -- all 20 Gram Panchayats against all 6 fiscal years, 120 rows -- so a **zero is a recorded zero**, not a missing row. It can mean either that nothing happened or that nothing was recorded, and this view cannot tell those apart. Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file.

`n\_tech\_approvals` totals **2,095**, not the 2,134 technical-approval records in the source: 39 sit on activities that have no administrative approval, and the approval view hangs the technical approval off the administrative one. The Ask chatbot reports the same 2,095, so the two systems agree. Activity-count comparisons across FY 2023-24 reflect a change in reporting completeness (costless activities begin being recorded), not a change in activity.
